PSORIASIS ASSOCIATION OF GHANA (PAG)

POLICY MEMORANDUM: Justification for National Health Insurance Scheme (NHIS) Coverage of Psoriasis Care in Ghana

Economic Modeling, Clinical Burden, and Healthcare Equity Recommendations

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Author: *Miss Ruth Adjoa Abeka (Founder & Executive Director) & PAG Health Policy Committee*

Executive Summary

Psoriasis is a chronic, painful, non-communicable autoimmune disease affecting millions globally, with tens of thousands suffering in silence across Ghana. In Ghana today, essential treatments are completely excluded from the National Health Insurance Scheme (NHIS) medicines list, forcing patients to pay 100% out of pocket.

The Economic Burden

A patient in Ghana spends an average of **GHS 1,500 to GHS 2,500 every single month** on essential topical therapies, emollients, and specialist consultations. For a household earning the national median wage, this cost is financially catastrophic, leading over 60% of patients to discontinue treatment.

Key Policy Recommendations to the Ministry of Health & NHIA:

1. **Formulary Inclusion:** Immediately add medical-grade fragrance-free emollients and first-line topical corticosteroids to the NHIS reimbursable medicines list.
2. **Regional Diagnostic Access:** Subsidize dermatological consultations and punch biopsy diagnostics at regional and teaching hospitals (Korle Bu, Komfo Anokye, Tamale Teaching Hospital).
3. **Preventing Disability:** Early management of plaque psoriasis directly prevents the onset of irreversible, high-cost psoriatic arthritis disability, yielding net-positive savings for Ghana Health Service.

For official inquiries: info@psoriasisgh.org | +233 (0)24 517 9569 | Michel Camp Road, Tema, Greater Accra